GRAMMY'S ALLIE BOOK



A STORYBOOK ABOUT ALLIE

ENGINE EDITION

A PERSONALIZED STORYBOOK

GRAMMY'S ALLIE BOOK · EN-GINE EDITION

RAMBLEBOOK

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ABOUT THIS DRAFT

Grammy's Allie Book · Engine Edition is a working draft, produced with RambleBook from an original story idea. It is complete as a story — beginning, middle, and end, in 6 chapters — and deliberately unfinished as a book. Chapter One is written at full weight; the chapters that follow are leaner, the way first drafts are: the bones and the heartbeat, waiting for a writer's second pass. Writing is rewriting. This is the draft you rewrite from.

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Chapter 1

Something Round

Allie flipped a pancake with her fork.

It landed halfway off her plate.

“An escape,” Grammy said.

Allie giggled and nudged it back. “You haven’t got any legs.”

Tap, tap, tap.

A silver paper airplane was bumping its nose against the window.



Allie stopped chewing.

Tap.

“Grammy. That airplane wants to come in.”

Grammy opened the window. The airplane swooped over the table and landed nose-first in the butter.

Allie's giggle came out as a squeak.

"Not a very good parking place."

She wiped its nose with a napkin. Then she unfolded its wings. Inside, in small, crooked letters, was a message:

"Moon picnic today. Please bring something round."

Allie looked at her plate.

She looked out at the pale Moon.

Then she held up a pancake.

"Breakfast already has the right shape!"

"Very convenient," said Grammy.

They packed the pancakes in a box with a snug lid. Allie was just checking the corners when the paper invitation wriggled.

It folded itself once.

Twice.

Then it flew outside.

On the grass, it grew.

Silver wings stretched wide. A door popped open. Two seats puffed up like cushions, and a little staircase unrolled with a noise like someone blowing their nose.

Allie laughed so hard she had to put down the box.

"Welcome aboard," said the rocket.

Allie stepped closer to Grammy. A talking rocket was different from a talking person, but it was still somebody new.

"Both of us?" she asked softly.

"Two seats. Two belts. One excellent view."

Grammy held out her hand.

Allie took it. With her other hand, she picked up their breakfast.

They climbed in and buckled up.

"Destination?" asked the rocket.

Allie glanced at Grammy, who nodded.

"The Moon," Allie said.

Then she added, "And no parking in anybody's butter."

The rocket gave a polite little beep.

Chapter 2

The Upside-Down Welcome

Allie pressed her nose to the rocket window as its silver feet settled onto the Moon.

Outside stood a little mouse holding a large sign.

His ears poked above it. His boots poked below it.

The letters were upside down.

The rocket's staircase unrolled with another splendid snort.

Allie giggled, then stopped when the mouse hurried over.

"Welcome! Welcome!" he called. "I'm so glad you came!"

Allie stayed close to Grammy. She held the breakfast box with both hands.

"Hello," said Grammy.

Allie gave a small wave with two fingers.

The mouse lifted his sign higher.

"Can you read it?"

Allie tipped her head sideways.

Then farther sideways.



Grammy tipped hers, too.

"Oh, dear," said the mouse. "Have I invited sideways people?"

A giggle escaped Allie.

"Your sign," she whispered.

"My sign?"

"It's upside down."

The mouse peered over the top. Then he ducked beneath the bottom.

"Ah," he said. "That explains why it was so easy to read while I carried it."

He turned it around.

WELCOME, said the sign.

Allie laughed, and the mouse laughed with her. His whiskers trembled like tiny skipping ropes.

"That's better," Allie said.

Beyond him lay a picnic blanket. Cups stood in a neat circle, but nobody sat beside them.

Allie looked around.

"Where are your other guests?"

The mouse's ears drooped.

“I don’t know. I put up arrows so nobody would get lost.”

He pointed toward a row of small signs leading away across the dust.

Allie followed the nearest arrow with her eyes.

It pointed away from the blanket.

So did the next.

“Did you read those while you carried them, too?” she asked.

The mouse blinked.

“Oh.”

He looked at his empty picnic.

Then he looked at Allie.

“I may have made it very easy to find somewhere else.”

Chapter 3

Breakfast on the Bounce

Allie took one corner of the picnic blanket. Grammy took another, and the Moon mouse gathered up the cups.

"Let's try nearer the rocket," Grammy said. "It's easier to spot than a blanket."

They carried the picnic across the pale dust. Every few steps, the mouse's boots lifted him into a little hop.

"Excuse me," he said each time.

"Who are you excusing?" Allie asked.

"The ground. I keep leaving it."

Allie giggled so hard that they had to stop and spread the blanket.

She set down the breakfast box and lifted its lid.

"Are the pancakes still—"

One pancake sprang over the edge.

"Here!" Allie squeaked.

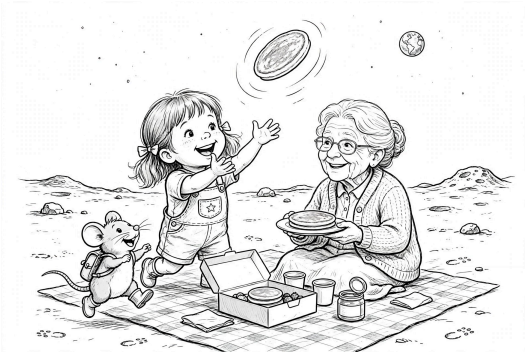
It landed on the blanket and bounced.

Up it went, turning slowly.

The mouse reached for it. His boots left the ground again.

“Excuse me!”

Allie caught the pancake against her palms.



For a moment, everyone was still.

Then a second pancake flopped out of the tilted box.

Boing.

Grammy caught that one.

“Breakfast,” she said, “seems unusually lively.”

Allie laughed until her middle wobbled. “They’re terrible travelers!”

She put her pancake back. It bumped another, which began to rise.

Allie quickly lowered the lid.

Underneath came a soft thup.

She looked at Grammy.

Grammy looked at the box.

“Perhaps we need a rescue station,” Grammy said.

She held the box steady while Allie opened one corner of the lid. The mouse passed over the pancake Grammy had caught.

“In you go,” Allie told it.

She slipped it inside and shut the lid.

Thup.

“No jumping without asking.”

Together, they carried the covered box to the rocket. This time, breakfast stayed put.

The mouse set down his cups and gazed across the empty Moon.

Allie noticed a wide crater nearby. She cupped her hands around her mouth.

“Maybe the guests just need somebody to call them.”

Chapter 4

Who Said “This Way”?

Allie leaned toward the crater and called, “This way!”

“This way!” called a voice.

She straightened.

“There’s somebody down there!”

The Moon mouse stood on tiptoe, well back from the edge.

“Hello?” he called.

“Hello?” said the voice.

Allie smiled. “Come to the picnic!”

“Come to the picnic!”

Her smile turned puzzled.

“That’s what I just said.”

“That’s what I just said.”

Allie looked at Grammy.

Grammy’s mouth twitched at the corners.

“Perhaps try something different,” she suggested.

Allie cupped her hands again.

“We’re beside the rocket!”

“We’re beside the rocket!”

“No, you aren’t,” Allie said. “We are.”

“We are.”

The mouse scratched one ear.

“This guest is very difficult to invite.”

Allie tried to be patient.

“Please follow my voice!”

“Please follow my voice!”

“But you’re following mine!”

The last word came out in a squeak. A giggle slipped after it.

From the crater came a faint, squeaky giggle.

Allie clapped a hand over her mouth.

The crater went quiet.

She took her hand away.

“Wiggly moon socks!”



“Wiggly moon socks!”

Allie folded over laughing.

“It’s me! Grammy, it’s only me!”

“An echo,” Grammy said. “Your voice is bouncing back.”

“Like breakfast,” Allie managed.

The mouse bent toward the crater.

“Thank you for explaining!”

“Thank you for explaining!”

“How polite,” he said.

That started Allie giggling all over again.

But when the laughter faded, the picnic blanket was still empty. Far away, something small moved past a pale ridge, then disappeared.

Allie waved both arms. Nobody waved back.

“Shouting won’t show them where we are,” she said. “The crater only shouts it back.”

She looked at the little welcome sign resting beside the cups.

Then she looked up at their tall silver rocket.

“We need a sign everyone can see.”

The mouse lifted his sign hopefully.

“I could stand on tiptoe again.”

Chapter 5

The Biggest Arrow

Allie laid the mouse's welcome sign on the blanket and folded its top corners inward.

"There," she said. "A point!"

The mouse tilted his head.

"My welcome has elbows."

Allie giggled. She folded the corners tighter, making a broad arrowhead.

"Can we use the sticks from your other signs?"

"Certainly," said the mouse. "They weren't giving very good directions anyway."

He brought two long sticks. Grammy found some napkins in the breakfast box and twisted them into ties.

Allie overlapped the sticks. Grammy tied them firmly together. Then they fastened the folded sign near one end, with its point aimed down.

Together, they lifted their tall arrow beside the rocket.

Grammy held the bottom steady.

Allie turned the arrowhead toward the picnic blanket.

“Here!” she said. “This says here without shouting.”

The mouse stepped back.

Then he stepped back farther.

“It’s very tall,” he said. “But from over here, it’s also very small.”

Allie’s shoulders sank a little.

Above her, the rocket’s lamp blinked.

Silver flashed across the sign.

Then darkness.

Then silver again.

Allie looked up.

“Could you blink at our arrow?”

“I thought nobody would ask,” said the rocket.

Its little lamp tipped downward.

Flash!

The arrow shone bright against the dim ground.



Flash!

Its point showed exactly where to go.

Allie bounced on her toes. “It’s waving!”

“With a very shiny elbow,” said the mouse.

They tucked the bottom of the pole between two rocks while Grammy steadied it. Allie checked that the arrow still pointed at the blanket.

Far beyond the crater, a tiny light blinked back.

Then something round bobbed above a ridge.

The mouse caught Allie’s hand.

“Is that a guest?”

Allie waved her free arm, grinning.

This time, a little arm waved back.

“Unless,” she said, “the Moon has learned to wave.”

Chapter 6

A Very Round Success

Allie lifted the breakfast-box lid just enough to slip one pancake onto a waiting plate.

"No escaping," she told it. "We have guests now."

The Moon mouse sat beside her. Around the blanket, new friends balanced cups, passed plates, and tucked their tails out of the way.

Every place was full.



One small mouse held a pancake in both paws.

"Which side is the top?"

"The side you don't drop," Allie said.

Grammy chuckled.

The mouse turned his pancake over to check. It floated out of his paws.

Allie caught it on his plate.

“That side!”

Soon everyone was giggling. Even the rocket gave a cheerful beep.

Allie passed the last pancake to the mouse who had invited them.

He looked around his crowded blanket.

“I thought nobody wanted to come.”

“They just needed to find you,” Allie said.

He broke his pancake in half and offered her a piece.

This time, she didn’t need to hide close to Grammy. She took it and smiled.

When the cups were empty, Allie helped fold the blanket. The tall arrow stayed beside the picnic spot.

“For next time,” said the mouse.

He hugged Allie, then Grammy, though Grammy’s hug required a little hop.

They climbed aboard with their empty breakfast box.

Allie waved until her new friends looked like crumbs.

The journey home felt soft and sleepy. She leaned against Grammy while the Moon grew small behind them.

Their rocket settled on the grass. Once they had stepped outside, its staircase rolled up.

Its wings folded.

Its seats vanished.

The whole silver rocket shrank into an envelope at Allie's feet.

She picked it up carefully.

"Worth keeping," Grammy said.

Allie carried it inside and set it beside the breakfast box.

Then she moved it a little farther from the butter.

"Just in case."

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

RambleBook makes storybooks about the people you love, from the details only you know.

A storybook to keep & share

Allie is 7 years old — silly, determined, curious all the way through. A keepsake storybook about Allie, made for Grammy to keep, to show, and to read aloud.